

eCBHFA Facilitator guide

Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 1: Introduction to blood donation

Learning objectives

On completing this topic, volunteers will be better able to:

- Explain the purpose of blood in our bodies
- Recount the history of blood transfusion and blood donation
- Explain why blood donors are needed

Suggested outline of activities

Section	Time
About blood	30 min
Blood types	30 - 45 min
Wrap-up	5 - 10 min

Materials and preparation

Materials

- Cards with outline of a human body with circulatory system shown (simplified), sufficient for each participant
- Four flipcharts with each of the four blood groups in the middle, with a positive (+) and negative (-) sign each side
- Flipchart with chart of donation and transfusion blood type guidance

Preparation

- Prepare a flipchart with learning objectives for the session and post at the front of the room
- Make sufficient copies of the volunteer manual topic for each participant

Topic summary

Volunteers have an important role in educating community members about why blood is so important for life and what it does in the body. They will learn about the effect that blood types have on donation and transfusion, and will discuss what they know about blood donation.

About blood

1. Welcome participants to the first topic of this new module. Point out the learning objectives for the topic on the flipchart. Tell them that they will be learning all about blood and what it does in our bodies, and that they will be responsible within their community for educating people about blood and the need for many more people to become voluntary, non-paid blood donors.
2. Give out the circulatory system cards. Explain that this is a very simple way of showing how the heart pumps blood around the body, bringing food and oxygen so that people have life and energy, and also taking away the used oxygen and food in the form of carbon dioxide and other waste.
3. Ask them to tell you what happens when you have a little cut on your finger. How long does it bleed? What would happen if this was a much bigger injury? Ask them if they know anyone who bled so much that they died? Perhaps it was a woman after a difficult childbirth who bled too much. Explain that if that happens, there is not sufficient blood to keep the body's cells alive and there is no artificial substitute for blood. It is a living resource and scientists cannot make a synthetic version, although they have tried.
4. Ask them to make up small groups of three or four. Hand out copies of the volunteer guide topic and ask them to quickly skim through the first section, and then discuss what they know about blood donation in their country and community. Is any member of the group a blood donor? Do they know anyone who is a blood donor? Circulate round the groups to ensure that they are keeping to the topic of blood donation and answer any queries they may have as you go round. At the end of 10 minutes, ask them to come back to the whole group and to call out any observations that have been made in their group about blood donation in the country and within their community.
5. Ask them the questions in the Reflection section and lead a brief discussion about the importance of blood and what happens when there is not enough blood in store to save lives.

Blood types

1. Place the four blood type flipcharts at four corners of the room.
2. Ask the group if anyone knows what their blood type is. If they do, ask them to go and stand by their blood type. To the others, explain that there are four types of blood, called A, B, AB and O. A very simple medical test shows you what your type is, but you will not know it just by looking. You are going to allocate them to one of the blood types for a game. As well as each of the types, their blood will also be either Rhesus positive or Rhesus negative, so you are going to tell them which. Go round allocating a blood type and a positive or negative factor to each person and ask them to go and stand by the flipchart with their blood type, either to the left

or the right depending on whether they are positive or negative.

3. Ask them to shake hands with the rest of the people in their group, both positive and negative, because they can donate their blood to each other and receive blood from each other without risk of a harmful reaction.
4. Now ask O+ to put up their hands. Then ask A+, B+ and AB+ to put up their hands. Tell O+ that these are people they can safely donate their blood to, but they cannot receive their blood. Ask O- to put up their hands. Tell O+ that these are the only people they can receive blood from, apart from the rest of their O+ group.
5. Go through the same exercise with AB+.
6. Make it clear that this is a game only to show how blood donation and transfusion are affected by blood types but that it is not something they need to learn by heart. If ever they needed to receive a blood transfusion, the guidance about who they can receive from is very clear, and the medical staff will know what it is, so there is no possibility that they will receive the “wrong” blood. The same applies to donating. Once they have become a blood donor, they will know their blood type, but it is not something that otherwise is essential to know.
7. Ask them to regain their seats and thank them for their cooperation.

Wrap-up

1. Revisit the learning objectives and ask if they feel they have achieved them.
 2. Ask if there any questions and if appropriate, ask if any member of the group can give answers.
 3. Tell them that in the next session, they will learn more about blood donation and the importance of donors being voluntary and non-paid.
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Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 2: Voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation

Learning objectives

At the end of this topic, volunteers will be able to:

- define voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation
- explain what makes a person ineligible to donate blood

Suggested outline of activities

Section	Time
What do you know about voluntary non-remunerated blood donation?	30 min
Eligibility to give blood	30 min
Wrap-up	5 - 10 min

Materials and preparation

Materials

- Card with definition of voluntary, non-remunerated blood donors

Preparation

- Prepare a flipchart with the topic objectives and post at the front of the room.
- Copy a sufficient number of the volunteer guide topic to give to each participant.

What do you know about voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation?

1. Welcome participants to this session. Tell them that they are going to look more closely at what voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation means and why some people are not eligible to give blood. Refer to the learning objectives and say that this session should help them to achieve them fully.
2. Give the definition card to a member of the group and ask him/her to read it out loud. Ask the group to tell you what they understand by the definition in their own words. Explain that the use of a term like "non-remunerated" implies not just money but anything else that could be considered as payment.
3. Ask them to get into groups of three or four and to discuss among themselves what the situation is in their country and community. Start them off with some

questions that you know would be relevant to the country's situation. For example, "Is there a national blood service?" "What happens if a person in hospital needs a blood transfusion?" "Do they ever see campaign material asking people to donate their blood?" "Is blood donation acceptable within their culture?"

4. After a discussion, ask them to go on to talk about what the main reasons are for insisting on voluntary, non-paid donors who donate through altruistic motives.
5. Bring them back to the full group and ask each small group to report on what they consider the main reasons are. Write up the main headings on a flipchart as they report. Then lead a discussion about the most important reasons, e.g. safety of the blood, protection of the recipient and the donor, healthy lifestyle of the donor, ethics.
6. Tell them that any donor who does not give blood voluntarily through altruistic motives poses a threat to the safety of the blood supply.

Eligibility to give blood

1. Tell the group that everyone is able to give blood, but not all person's blood is acceptable to the blood service because it may not be "safe". Tell them that by safe you mean that the blood is healthy and does not carry any infection or disease. Explain that it is better for the blood service if those people who are not eligible exclude themselves, rather than be excluded once their blood has been taken and tested, which costs the blood service time and money.
2. The volunteer guide topic gives a set of criteria which may be in place in the country, or there may be slightly different ones, but all with the same aim, i.e. to identify those people who lead healthy lifestyles and are safe to give blood versus those who are not eligible because of various reasons. Ask them to look through the list and to see what those reasons are. Go through each one in turn and ask them to say why they think it is on the list.
3. Ask them to get back into their small groups and to discuss how they might, with tact and sensitivity, discourage ineligible donors in their community from going to donate, while at the same time encourage people at low risk to become voluntary non-remunerated blood donors. 4. After 15 minutes, ask each group to report some of their discussion to the wider group. Tell them to keep notes of any parts of the discussion that could be useful to them in their future dealings with community members.
5. Thank them for their hard work.

Wrap-up

1. Return to the learning objectives and ask if they feel they have achieved them. Ask if there are any questions and allow any member of the group to answer those they feel they can.
2. Tell them that the next session is about the different components in blood and what each does.

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Topic 3: Components of blood

Learning objectives

At the end of this topic, volunteers should be better able to:

- Describe the main components of blood and explain why components are usually separated after donation
- List the main uses for each blood component and the lifespan of each

Suggested outline of activities

Section	Time
What is blood made of?	45 - 60 min
Consequences of shelf life on blood donation	20 - 25 min
Wrap-up	5 - 10 min

Materials and preparation

Materials

- Blood donation and composition card
- A small blood sample in a vial (with a non-clotting agent)

Preparation

- Prepare a flipchart with the learning objectives for the topic and place at the front of the room.
- Prepare sufficient copies of the volunteer guide topic.

What is blood made of?

1. Welcome participants to this session about the different components that make up blood and how each is used in transfusion therapy. Draw their attention to the learning objectives for the topic and tell them that this session is designed to help them achieve those objectives.
2. Give out the volunteer guide topic and ask them to spend a brief time looking through.

3. Tell the volunteers that they have an important role within the community in educating community members about the importance of blood. They have already seen how it works to give life to the cells when it is pumping food and oxygen round the body and removing waste. But now they will look at what blood is made of and the specific job that each part of it does.
4. Pass round the vial with the blood sample. Ask if they can see the different parts that make up the blood. It's clear that you cannot tell the different components. Ask them what happens with a blood stain on a piece of cloth. It dries and goes brown. This is because the largest part of blood is water that dries up.
5. Tell them that when they are explaining about blood components to community members they will need to know what each component does and how long it can be kept once donated. Also what the main uses of each component are in the health service. Explain that in general these days, when blood is donated, it is separated into its component parts, which each component able to be used for a specific purpose.
6. Ask participants to get into groups of three. Tell them that in each group, one will choose to play the part of plasma, one platelets and one red blood cells. Using the topic in the volunteer guide, they should then imagine that they are talking to a group in the community and will each explain what their particular component does and what it is used for. Give them an example of what you want them to do: "Hello, I'm plasma. There's more of me in blood than the other parts. I'm very important because I'm a liquid that carries all the other parts. I also carry other substances like proteins, clotting factors and chemicals. When I'm separated from the other parts after blood donation, I'm often used for patients with burns, those suffering from shock and bleeding disorders (such as haemophilia, which is a condition where the blood does not clot). I'm pretty useful as well as important because I can be frozen and kept in store for up to a year".
7. Ask them if possible to make their explanations quite imaginative. They should act out if possible what actions the components take, for example, platelets rush to the scene of an injury and stick to the surfaces of the blood vessels to help the plasma bring the clotting factors to stop the bleeding quickly. They are used often in cancer, organ transplants and major surgery. The only problem is that they can only be kept in storage for five days. Red blood cells are tireless in carrying oxygen and used oxygen in the form of carbon dioxide so the body can get rid of it. They're used for anaemia (low iron in the blood), blood loss, some blood disorders, major surgery and trauma, such as an accident. They can be stored for around six weeks.
8. When they have all had a chance to play their part in their group, ask the wider group to comment on how easy or difficult it was to get across the action that a component takes. Lead a brief discussion on using this information with community groups and ask them to take notes of any suggestions that seem particularly useful or relevant to them to make their job more interesting and entertaining to their listeners.

Consequences of shelf life on blood donation

1. Remind participants that in the last activity, they touched on how long each component could be kept. Tell them that whole blood, used in surgery and trauma and often used solely in less developed countries because they do not have the facilities to separate the blood, can be kept for 21–35 days.
2. Remind them that each unit of blood taken from a donor can save the lives of up to three people if the components are separated. If they are not, then only one life can be saved.
3. Ask them to brainstorm what the consequences of the shelf life of each component are in terms of the need for blood donors.
4. They should say that clearly, the main consequence is a shortage of blood and its components when they are needed. The consequences of shortages could be the deaths of people because there is simply not enough blood to serve everyone who needs it.
5. Ask them to translate that into the kind of activity they could, together with other volunteers, undertake with community groups in order to get across the importance of recruiting and retaining regular blood donors. As an example, they might consider using drama. What could they do? What are the main messages they would wish to convey? Give them an example of acting out a scenario where someone is dying from blood loss and there is not enough stored in the area to help him. The actors could be worried medical staff and frantic relatives. A second scenario might be showing a baby being given a blood transfusion because there were plenty of donors and blood components stored. Then show the baby as a healthy child a few years later.
6. Other possibilities for getting the message across about the need for blood donors will be looked at in the next topic, when they will explore myths, fears and superstitions about blood and learn how to counter any negative beliefs that will stop people wanting to become voluntary blood donors.
7. Thank them for their contributions and ask them to take a note of any particular activity or action that has been suggested during the brainstorm that might help them to be successful in conveying the right message about the need for voluntary blood donation.

Wrap-up

1. Revisit the learning objectives for the topic and ask the volunteers if they think they have achieved them.
 2. Tell them that in the next topic, they are going to look more closely at voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation and how it benefits both blood donor and recipient of the blood.
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Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 4: Blood donors are heroes!

Learning objectives

At the end of this topic, volunteers will be better able to:

- Explain fully the importance of VNRBD
- Explain the benefits of being a blood donor
- Explain the benefits of blood donation for recipients
- Discuss some common fears and concerns about blood donation
- Motivate others to donate blood

Suggested outline of activities

Section	Time
Who benefits from VNRBD	15 min
Myths, fears and superstitions: the fact flow game	30-45 min
Wrap-up	5-10 min

Materials and preparation

Materials

- Fact flow game
- Donor case studies

Preparation

- Prepare a flipchart of the learning objectives and place at the front of the room.
- Prepare sets of the fact flow game (there will be four players in a group). They should, however, each go away with one set to use in the community.
- Make sufficient copies of the donor case studies for each participant.

Who benefits from VNRBD?

1. Welcome participants to this topic. Explain that they are going to look in more depth at voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation and how it benefits both the blood donor and the blood recipient.
2. Ask them to think back to the activity they did in Topic 2 where they explored the main reasons for insisting on blood donors being voluntary and non-paid. Ask them to call out what these most important reasons were: safety of the blood, protection of the recipient and the donor, healthy lifestyle of the donor, ethics.

3. Ask them to think about why donors who are volunteers and non-paid are likely to be the safest donors. In small groups of three or four, ask them to discuss motivation and to record some points that might motivate a voluntary, non-paid donor. At the end of the discussion time, ask each group to report on their responses. If they do not mention any of the following, bring them to their attention: altruism, feeling good about themselves, informed about the need for healthy blood, service to their own community and to humanity as a whole, giving something back, gaining recognition and appreciation from others.
4. Ask them to consider whether a paid donor, or a family/replacement donor would have the same motivation. Explain that while a family member who donates when a loved one requires blood may well be healthy, he is still under emotional pressure at that time, and cannot be considered voluntary, even if not paid. That means that he has no reason to be totally honest about his health status and may hide information that could make him ineligible to donate blood. The same applies to paid donors.
5. Tell them that voluntary donation is also ethical. In 1991, at the World Assembly, the World Health Organization declared, "The human body and its parts cannot be used for commercial ends. Monetary exchange (including any compensation or payment) for organs must be prohibited". Blood is included in this prohibition.
6. Tell them that it's quite clear that blood from voluntary, non-remunerated donors benefits the recipient. Many of them would die without the donated blood, which, coming from voluntary donors is most likely to be the healthiest blood without risk of infection. But how does voluntary, non-paid donation benefit the donor?
7. Ask them to revisit the activity they did on motivation and to consider how that motivation leads to feelings of well-being, commitment to society and to the community, feelings of virtue and of having done a good deed. Gaining recognition and being appreciated is beneficial too. We all like to be appreciated and to be thought heroes.
8. Tell them that when they are encouraging community members to become voluntary, non-paid blood donors, the motivations and the feelings they engender can be part of a strong message. In the same small groups as before, ask them to construct a few statements, not more than three, which give this strong message to the community. They should try to be creative about their statements – make them amusing, dramatic, rhyme them, sing them. At the end of the discussion, ask each group in turn to demonstrate the statement that they consider the strongest and most appropriate for their community.
9. Tell them that they can add to the strong messages the fact that voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation benefits the community as a whole, as it encourages healthy lifestyles and combined with other health programmes, can lead to a generally healthier community.

Myths, fears and superstitions: the fact flow game

1. Ask participants to get into groups of four. They are going to play the fact flow game. This game can be used with community members to give facts about blood donation and to dispel some myths, fears and superstitions. Overcoming negative feelings about blood donation is a major factor in their job of recruiting voluntary, non-remunerated blood donors from the community. Motivating people to go and donate is the goal of their work with their community.
2. Give out one set of the game to each group. Explain the rules and ask them to start playing. It should not take more than half an hour.
3. Once they have all finished the game, ask the winner in each group to stand up, and lead a round of applause.
4. Ask the group how easy or difficult it was to get the answers right. Did they learn anything new? Tell them that many of the false statements will be the concerns of community members, and it is their job to put them right. Playing this game with groups in the community might well be a good way of dispelling myths, fears and superstitions.
5. Hand out the donor case studies and ask them to use these stories as a basis for the kinds of stories they should be looking for from community members. Real-life stories from people within their own community are a powerful tool. They should be trying to develop a pool of such stories so that they can use the most appropriate ones with different groups of community members, e.g. the story about the dying child would have a great impact on mothers with babies or small children.

Wrap-up

1. Revisit the learning objectives for the topic and ask if they feel they have achieved them. Ask if there are any questions or concerns about what they learnt today.
 2. Tell them that in the next topic they will complete the module on blood donation by looking at the blood donation process itself, so that they can explain to community members what to expect when they go to donate, and what happens to the blood after donation.
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Module: Voluntary Non-Remunerated Blood Donation

Topic 5: Let's donate

Learning objectives

At the end of this topic, volunteers should be better able to:

- Explain how to estimate the amount of blood needed in a set location
- List the general steps that a blood donor goes through when she/he goes to a blood centre to donate blood
- Describe the process that donated blood goes through once it is donated

Suggested outline of activities

Section	Time
Estimating blood needs	20 min
The blood donation process	20-30 min
Blood donation, blood processing and the community	20-30 min
Wrap-up	5-10 min

Materials and preparation

Materials

- Population figures example
- Calculators

Preparation

- Prepare a flipchart with the learning objectives and place at the front of the room.
- If possible, for the first activity use real population figures that come from your region for a city, small village and medium-sized town.

Estimating blood needs

1. Welcome participants to this topic. Refer to the learning objectives for the topic and explain that this is a very practical session where the blood donation process will be examined and the various processes that happen to blood after donation. Before that, however, they are going to find out how much blood is needed. Explain that this is not something they would be expected to do in their job as a community volunteer, but it would be very helpful in their talks with community members to be able to show them numerically that more regular voluntary, non-

paid blood donors are needed. Without sufficient donated blood, people die, and those people might well be loved ones, friends or neighbours, children as well as adults. Blood cannot be stored for very long, so to ensure an adequate supply all the time, more donors are needed.

2. Ask them to work in small groups of three or four. Hand out the population figures, either the ones provided or some more local figures that you have prepared, and ask them to work out the need for blood units per year and then per week. Give a calculator to each group. Remind them, it is two per cent to get the figure for the year (i.e. they should be multiplying by 0.02. Then divide by 52 to get the figure needed per week. They can round up to the nearest whole number. Then ask them to suppose that suitable donors give two donations a year and to work out how many donors would be needed. They should not forget, however, that even regular donors sometimes have a break or cannot donate at their usual time because they have been unwell. So in reality, to be sure of a continuous supply of blood, even more donors would be required than estimated.
3. Give them a few minutes to do the calculations, then ask for answers. They should have 3280 units per year and 63 units per week for Hareng City. That would be 1640 donors. Bizzaville, 54 and 1 with 27 donors and Tarbridge, 150 and 3 with 75 donors. Point out to them, based on the population estimates, that even a smallish village with around 500 families (such as Bizzaville) could well have a need for 54 units of blood a year, one a week. If that blood is separated into its components, then more than 150 people in need of blood could be treated.
4. Explain that they can use this information to educate community members with more accurate information about the need for blood and donors if they use their own population figure and work out how many units of blood might be needed in a week. Remind them people react better to something that they can relate to personally and realise that it is their own situation that you are presenting.

The blood donation process

1. Use the blood donation process poster to point out the five steps that go into making a blood donation. Ask if anybody is already a blood donor and if so, ask them to describe the steps in more detail. For Step 1, ask them to say how difficult or easy are the forms you have to fill in. What kind of information is asked for? For Step 2, medical screening, ask them what the health worker does, and what kind of things do they ask. For Step 3, ask them if they know what the haemoglobin check is all about and what is it like. For Step 4, ask them what happens and how long it takes. For Step 5, ask them what they are given to eat or drink and how long do they have to stay there resting. If you do not have any donors, describe the steps yourself.
2. Ask the group to look closely at the blood donation process poster and consider how they might use it with community groups. Give them an example of what you are looking for. Say that as an example a small group of volunteers could work together to put on a short play with one of them playing a first-time donor, a second playing a health worker, and a third playing a nurse. They could act out the blood donation process to reassure their audience that it is a simple process, does not hurt (much) and does not do them any harm. They should remind the audience that the blood taken will be made up by the body in a matter of days.

3. Ask them to get into small groups of three or four and to think of ways they might work together to present the donation process in a non-threatening and entertaining way to the community. At the end of the discussion, ask each group to give some ideas to the rest of the participants. Good ideas and suggestions should be noted for future reference.
4. Thank them for their hard work and encourage them to become voluntary, non-remunerated blood donors themselves if they are not already donating. Say that their good example would go a long way to persuading people that voluntary non-paid blood donation is not just acceptable but should be positive encouraged in their community.

Blood donation, blood processing and the community

1. Tell participants that this last activity is going to bring together all the information they have about blood donation and about voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation in particular. It will include what happens to the blood after it is donated.
2. Remind participants about the components of blood that they learnt about in Topic 3. Tell them that they do not really need to know in great detail how blood is separated into its components, but they do need to know enough to answer the questions of community members who quite rightly will want to know what happens to the blood that they donate.
3. Split participants into two equal-sized groups at each side of the room. One group will be community members, the other group will be CBHFA volunteers. Ask the community members to think about any questions they might ask about any aspect of blood donation before they decide to become a blood donor. Questions should include asking about what blood does in the body, why it cannot be made by scientists, why blood donors need to be voluntary and non-paid, what the benefits are to the recipient and to the general community, how safe is the blood given in terms of passing on infections, why some people are not suitable to give blood, why it is not always possible to give your blood to a particular person, how much blood is needed, what the donor gets out of it, and so on.
4. If they have a question, ask them to hold their hand up, and you will choose who will ask the first question. Ask for a CBHFA volunteer from the other side to answer the question. Ask if anyone else would like to give a different answer. Once everyone has had an opportunity to ask a question, change sides and ask the original CBHFA volunteer side to become community members and to ask their own questions. It is fine if some questions are more or less the same, as reinforcement of messages is beneficial.
5. When all have asked their questions, ask if any particular questions were more difficult to answer. If so, then lead a discussion about why. You may find that a particular topic or theme in the module needs to be briefly revisited.

Wrap-up

1. Revisit the learning objectives for the topic. Ask if they feel that they have achieved those objectives.
 2. Tell the participants that they have reached the end of the voluntary, non-remunerated blood donation module and that they should now have all the information they need to go out into the community and recruit more voluntary, non-remunerated blood donors. Ask if they feel they are ready and motivated to do so. Remind them that if they are not already donating blood, they should self-recruit to set a good example to the rest of the community, as well as to know that every donation they give saves lives.
 3. Thank them for their hard work during the module.
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